



Framings on Alignment

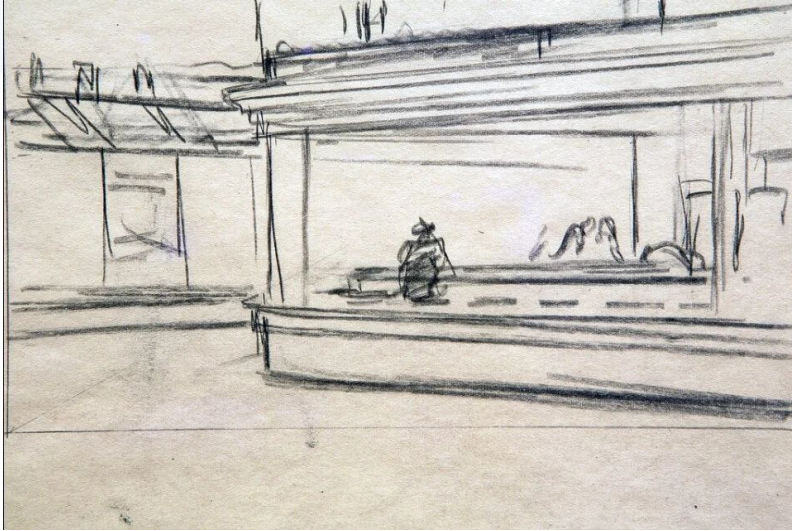
By Michaelangelo
Caporale

About Me

- ◆ Majored in Applied Math
 - Enjoy abstract thinking
- ◆ Solutions Consultant (Gen AI)
 - Enjoy designing solutions
- ◆ Now exploring
 - **Collective Flourishing**

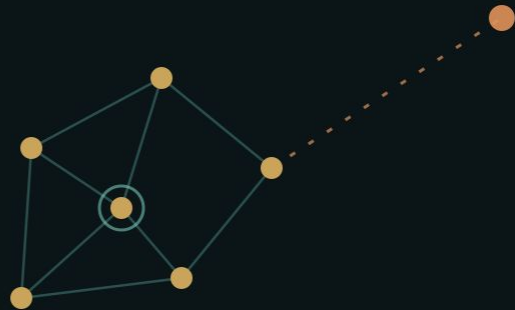


About this Talk: A General Sketch



I.

Narrow Alignment



A Conversation with ChatGPT

Q What is society's deepest problem? Think very deeply. Get as close to the fundamental root as you can.

A We keep building systems (markets, media, schools) that optimize for proxies (money, clicks, votes) faster than we can align those proxies to what we actually value.

Reframing the AI Alignment Problem

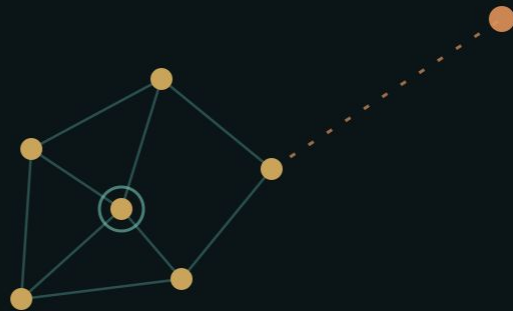
Will an AI system pursue the goals its designers intended?

and

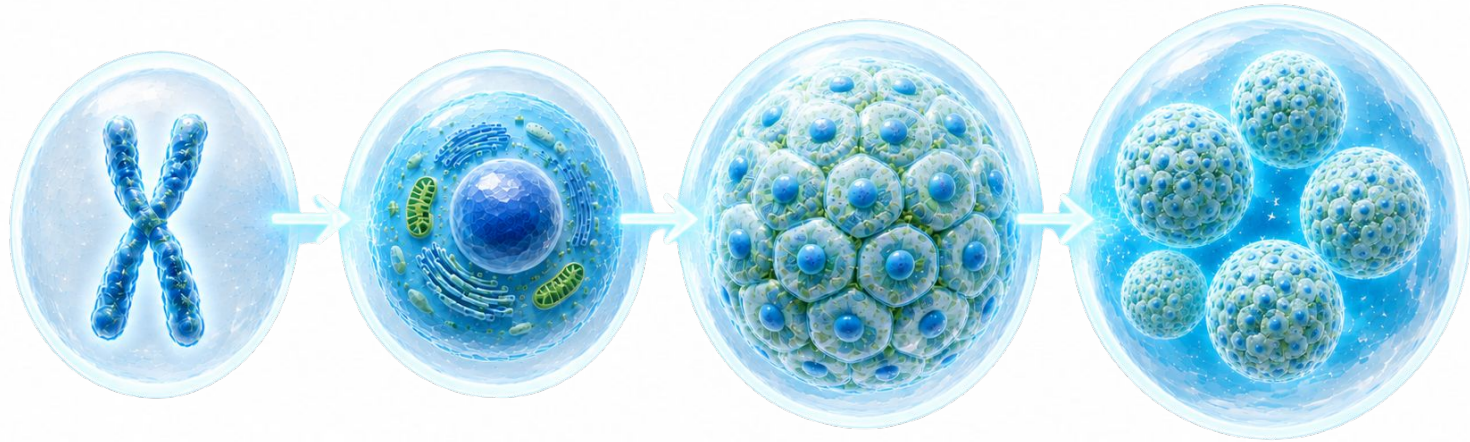
What happens when AI inherits the objective landscape we've already built?

II.

General Alignment



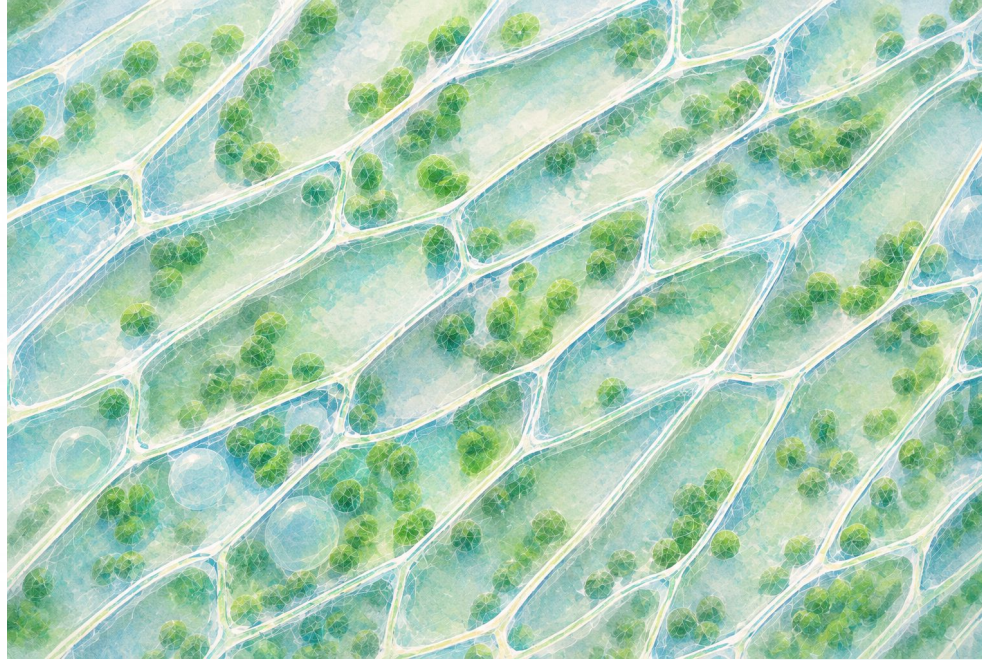
A Lesson From Evolution



Increasing coordination

Greater shared fate

Alignment is a Story about Coupling



Local signals are tied to the global state

Candidate Definition of Alignment

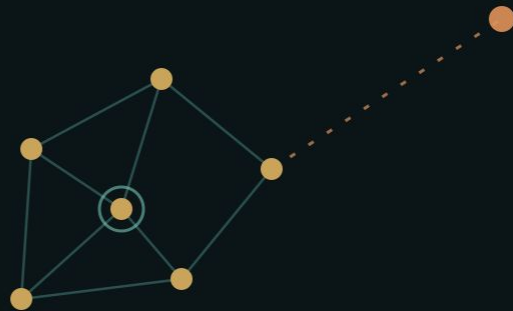
Def: A system is aligned when its parts and its whole can only descend their free energy gradients together.

Implications on this Definition

- ◆ You can't align an agent in isolation
- ◆ Health of a system = maintaining desired state
- ◆ Stacked alignment = recursively applying the principle
- ◆ Externalities = the shared signal dropped fate-relevant information.

III.

Implications



Degenerate Cases: Align to what?

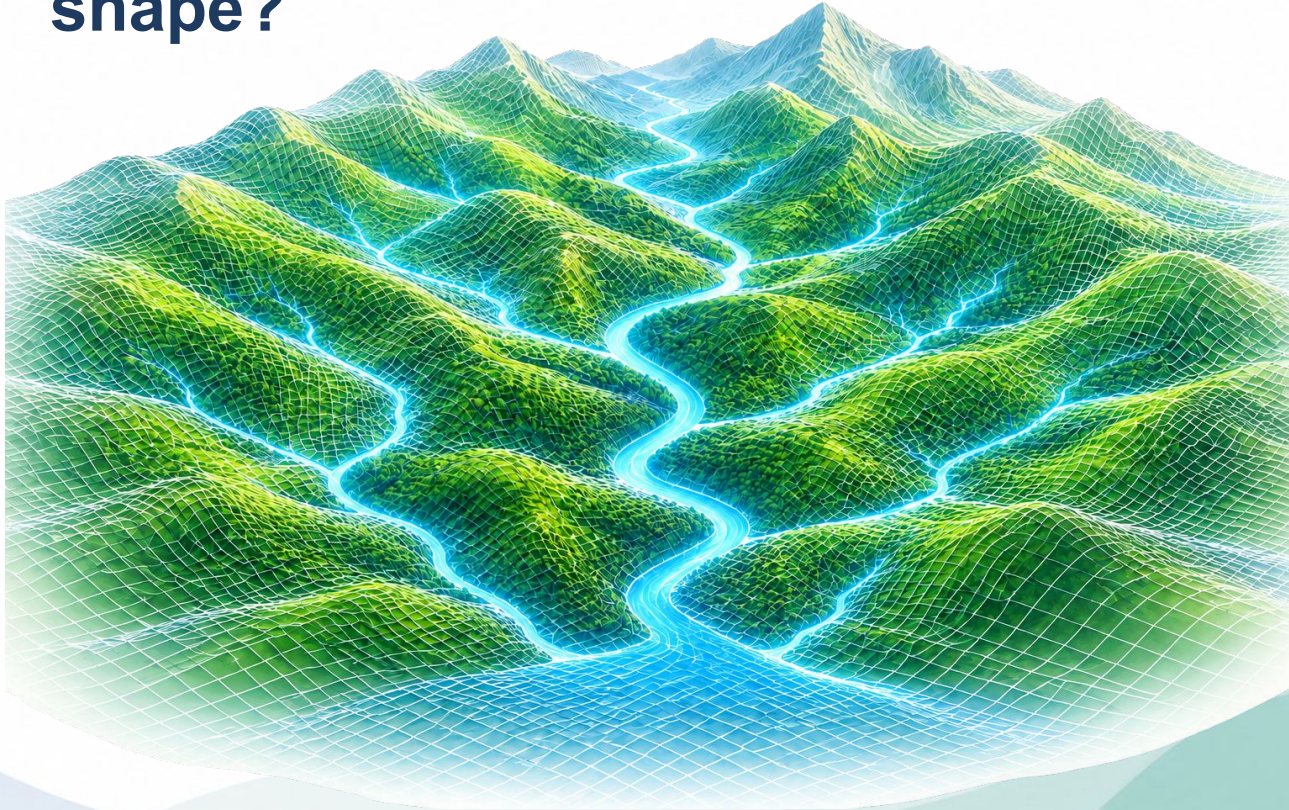
On the scale of the body:

- ◆ Every day, your body produces a hundred billion new immune cells and removes the old ones.

On the scale of the Earth:

- ◆ What if we decided to create an ice age

We can create a landscape, but what shape?



Leverage Points by Donella Meadows

- #6 the structure of information flows
- #3 is the goals of the system
- #2 is the mindset or paradigm out of which the system arises
- #1 is the power to transcend paradigms

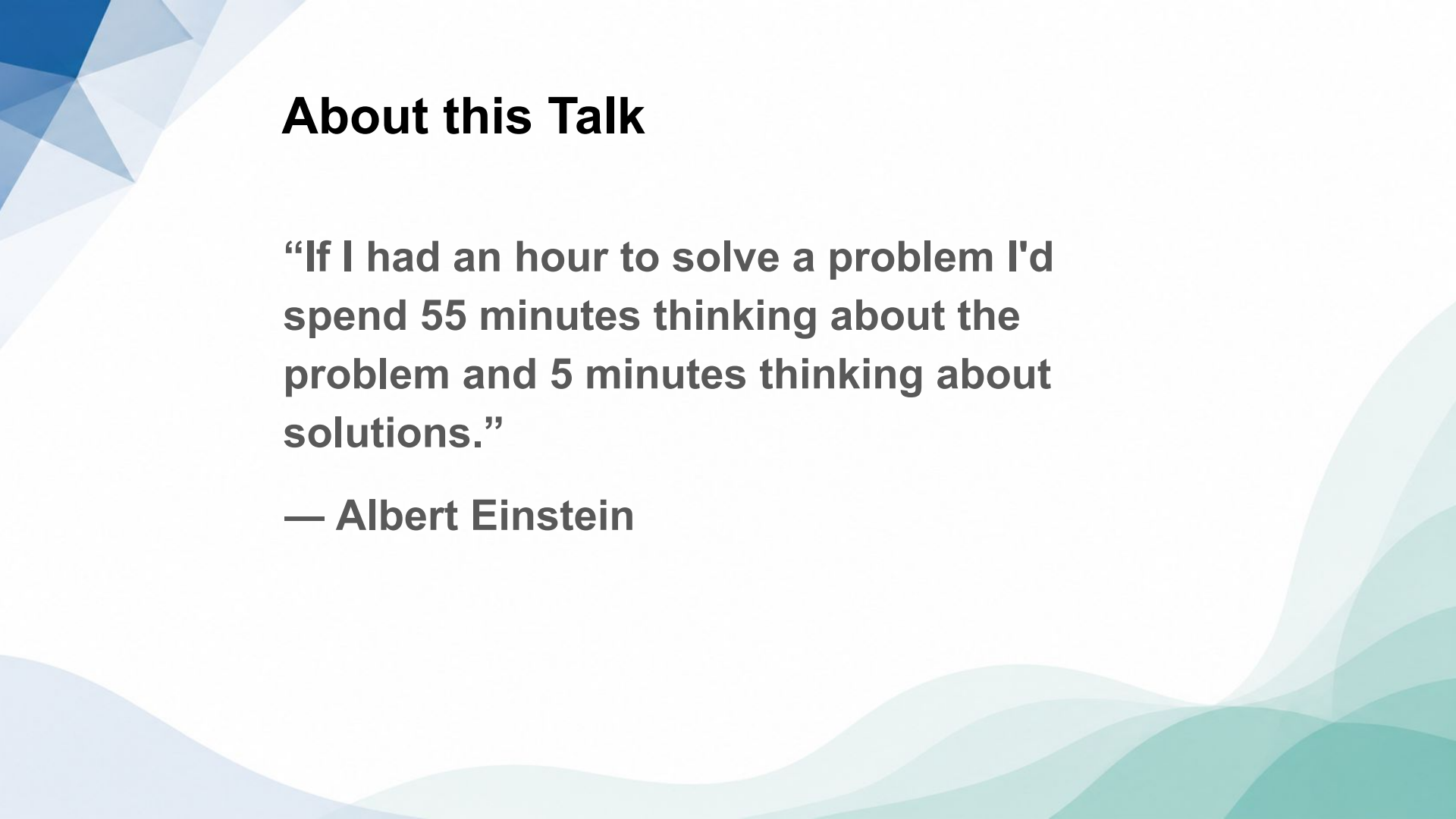
Ultimate Goal: Alignment to the Biosphere



Thank you!



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About this Talk

“If I had an hour to solve a problem I'd spend 55 minutes thinking about the problem and 5 minutes thinking about solutions.”

— Albert Einstein

